

Password Reset & Account Unlock

Department:	IT Help Desk	Document Owner:	IT Help Desk Lead
Version:	1.8	Effective Date:	2023-11-01
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1. Purpose

Provide a secure, efficient process for resetting user passwords and unlocking locked accounts in Active Directory and cloud systems.

2. Scope

All employees and contractors with company-managed accounts. Excludes service accounts (see SOP-IT-009).

3. Procedure

Step 1: Receive Reset Request

User submits ticket via helpdesk portal, calls support line, or walks in. Ticket is auto-assigned to the first available help desk agent. P2 priority for account lockouts affecting productivity.

Step 2: Identity Verification

Agent verifies identity using two factors: (1) Employee ID or badge number, (2) Answer to pre-registered security question or manager confirmation email. Never reset password over email without verification. Log verification method in ticket.

Step 3: Perform Reset in AD

Log into Active Directory Users & Computers. Locate user account, right-click, and select 'Reset Password'. Generate a random 14-character temporary password. Check 'User must change password at next logon'. If locked, uncheck 'Account is locked out'.

Step 4: Communicate Credentials

Call the user directly or use secure messaging (not email) to provide temporary password. Never include passwords in email or ticket notes. Confirm user can log in successfully before closing ticket.

Step 5: MFA Re-enrollment (if needed)

If user also lost MFA access, initiate re-enrollment via the self-service portal link. Document MFA reset in ticket for audit purposes.

Step 6: Update & Close Ticket

Document steps taken in ticket. Mark resolved once user confirms access. Tickets auto-close after 48 hours of inactivity post-resolution.

4. References & Related Documents

- Password Policy v2.0
- Identity Verification Standard IT-SEC-003
- MFA Policy IT-SEC-005

5. Revision History

Version	Date	Description of Change
1.8	2023-11-01	Added MFA re-enrollment step
1.7	2023-05-01	Strengthened identity verification
1.6	2022-09-01	Initial version